

Hot and Cold

Initial idea

- Polar bear moved to hot country to be with long distance partner. Struggles with climate, pays a lot of money for a climate controlled home, doesn't go outside much. Partner always wants to go out and enjoy things, complains that their home is always too cold. Work for him isn't climate controlled and he struggles. Mood in heat is aggressive. Risk of losing job. Believes he's doing the right thing.
- Big fight with partner and she breaks it off with him. He's devastated and loses his job, falling into depression. Can't keep up payments on his home. Spiralling out of control. More aggressive and angry than ever. Mourns his lost partner who moved out and keeps her distance.
- Has an online friend who picks up his spirits and encourages him to try selling his writing work more seriously. As he stays inside so much, he has a lot of unpublished material. He goes for it, has a lucky break on one while others flop. Heartened by progress, comes back to himself, growing closer to his friend.
- His partner tried to get back with him but he kindly turns her down. Ends with him at home, paid off most bills, happy again talking to his friend. Wants to meet for a date but worries he'll have them same problem with them. "It's ok. I don't like going outside much either."

Revised plan

- A polar bear has moved to a hot country for his long-distance partner, who is a Spanish ibex (set in Spain). Begins with him having sex with his partner, only for it to be revealed after they reach climax that he has lost his job due to his inability to deal with the heat. Note: he becomes angry and aggressive in excessive heat and has no respite from it in his office job – it was going to blow up in his face eventually.
- He storms out, though the outside doesn't offer him any respite. Reveal that lots of furs that move to other countries that aren't suited to their species invest in climate controlled homes. Unfortunately, he has never had the money to afford this. He spends some time in a coffee shop messaging his online friend – a seal who lives nearby but who he hasn't had the time to meet as yet (she's always been busy doing something else, sadly). She comforts him and assures him that her home is always open to him if he needs a place to stay.
- An Iberian wolf in the street takes an interest in him and asks if he's looking to make some money – the bear thinks the wolf is talking drugs and is aggressive at first. However, it transpires that the wolf works as a floor manager at a strip club and believes that the bear would be a big hit. He muses over it and is persuaded to join them for a show – one night, one time deal. Speaks to his seal friend about it and she seems excited for him – perhaps unduly so, considering that they are "just friends". He almost backs out, but is encouraged on by her faith in him. He wishes he could have that level of faith from his girlfriend and finds himself wondering what on earth went wrong.
- Sneaks out of his home while his girlfriend watches TV that evening to go to the strip club. Introduced to the 'team' and given an outfit to wear that doesn't really hide all that much. He is shocked to find that, going out on stage, his area is cooled to the correct temperature for his kind and the bright lights filtered so as not to add extra heat to the stage. The host laughs and ushers him on, saying that they have to keep a cool area if they want to lure in exotics. Emboldened, he does his best and finds

himself enjoying his too-short time on stage, going solo as he has stressed that he has a girlfriend to the host.

- Considerably happier and with a wad of tips in his pocket, he goes home only to find his girlfriend waiting up with him. They have an explosive argument in which his newfound work is revealed and she kicks him out, screaming that she doesn't want a 'stripper boyfriend', that it degrades her. She is only thinking of herself and he can finally see her in the light she's presented herself as all along. As he collects his meagre possessions – he didn't bring much with him when he moved – he calls his friend and asks her if he can stay. She is hesitant but says that he is welcome to her home.
- He finds her home and is surprised to find it with a ramp leading up to the door – how strange. When she opens the door to him, however, all is revealed as the seal is in a wheelchair. She takes him inside and explains that her legs never developed so her body is a hybrid of anthro and feral (note: need a different word for feral here) so she will never, ever be able to walk. She says she understands if he'd rather not be associated with her – people say she's a freak – but the bear takes her paws and adamantly insists that. Something pulls at his heart when looking into her eyes, but he refuses to acknowledge it at that time and goes to bed on her sofa, full of mixed feelings.
- They live together for some time, enjoying their time together more and more and growing closer. With his increased earnings, the bear will be able to afford a climate controlled home soon but something holds him back – the thought of leaving the seal. He knows she 'needs' her home back, not have him kipping on the sofa every night, but is reluctant to go. It becomes clear that she has little to her life besides her home as she cannot drive and getting anywhere on public transport is a nightmare that she loathes. She doesn't like going outside even though she is as able as anyone else if she gets in the water.
- She joins him at the club one night and cheers him on from the sidelines – he is much, much more experienced on stage at this point. It is a club that welcomes males and females, but her being in a wheelchair does raise some eyebrows so he gets the host of the night to keep an eye on her. He is jealous, however, when the host and the seal become a little too friendly for his liking and leans towards his aggressive side again, exploding at the host in the back. He is sent off on his own to cool down and he thunders into the alleyway at the back of the club, thinking he has lost the seal – something more – almost as soon as he realised what he had. But he thinks she doesn't feel the same as, well, she wants him to leave her home...right?
- He says little to the seal but gathers his belongings and moves out to his climate controlled home. It is far more comfortable for him, yet something is missing – her. He goes back on his (figurative) paws and knees, begging her to listen to him and explaining what happened. He is ashamed of himself for how he behaved, how he treated her – he can't control who she talks to and has no 'right' to her – and pleads for forgiveness. She does forgive him and he asks if he can make it up to her.
- Takes the seal out to the ocean – a remote cove – so that she can enjoy herself. He has a car now so can take her wherever she needs or wants to go, allowing her more freedom in her life. There is not any swimwear that is really suited to her bottom half so she shyly gets into the water, with his assistance, and finds her element. He joins her, with her acceptance, and they swim together as she darts back and forth, accidentally brushing against him until he realises that the teasing is no accident by far. His heart soars. She wants him after all! He was wrong! She never wanted him to leave!

- Ends with the sex scene in the ocean, the seal finally able to move freely and not be wheelchair bound. Sweet, loving and romantic feel – first time for these two together, but the first time of many.